CELPIP EXPRESS

Listening Test

STUDY MATERIALS - 1

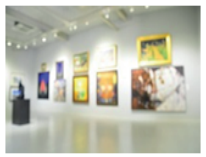
PART 1

Listening to Problem Solving

Question 1 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ to request a drink
- ◯ to check the route
- ◯ to ask for more time
- ◯ to leave the bus tour

Question 2 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

◯ 

◯

◯

◯

Question 3 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ All of the tour stops involve art.
- ◯ The art museum is the main attraction.
- ◯ The bus will stop at many places.
- ◯ There are not many people on the tour.

Question 4 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ He wants more time to walk around the area.
- ◯ He doesn't want to eat with the group.
- ◯ He isn't content with the restaurant choice.
- ◯ He prefers to eat something healthier.

Question 5 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question.

- ◯ She is a big fan of vegetarian food.
- ◯ The tour company owns the restaurant.
- ◯ She feels responsible for the group.
- ◯ There are too many children in the group.

Question 6 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ He doesn't know where his umbrella is.
- ◯ He wasn't prepared for rainy weather.
- ◯ He left the restaurant a while ago.
- ◯ He is upset with the tour guide.

Question 7 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ She offers him some solutions.
- ◯ She asks the bus driver to go back.
- ◯ She gives him her rain jacket.
- ◯ She buys him a new umbrella.

Question 8 of 8: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ excitement
- ◯ anger
- ◯ confusion
- ◯ appreciation

PART 2

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

Question 1 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a swimming pool
- ◯ a sprinkler playground
- ◯ the location of the park benches
- ◯ the increasing water shortages

Question 2 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It does not have air conditioning.
- ◯ It is a long way from the park.
- ◯ It is close to a swimming pool.
- ◯ It is very close to a bus stop.

Question 3 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ She feels hot.
- ◯ She looks sad.
- ◯ She isn't playing.
- ◯ She isn't there.

Question 4 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ Minji is not a strong swimmer.
- ◯ They cost too much to use.
- ◯ She is concerned about germs.
- ◯ They are always too crowded.

Question 5 of 5: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ It would make a lot of money.
- ◯ There is no space for it.
- ◯ No one would use it.
- ◯ It is an excellent idea.

PART 3

Listening for Information

Question 1 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ He hasn't had lessons since he was five.
- ◯ He's learned to play two instruments.
- ◯ He hasn't had any formal music instruction.
- ◯ His friends taught him how to play the drums.

Question 2 of 6: Choose the best answer

- ◯ He enjoys playing music.
- ◯ He wants to join a band.
- ◯ He needs an instrument for school.
- ◯ He dreams of being a rock star.

Question 3 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ provide the best information
- ◯ sell the most expensive product
- ◯ offer a chance to purchase both
- ◯ sell a full set of drums

Question 4 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ a drum set that can be kept at the store
- ◯ a drum shield that will reduce the noise
- ◯ an electronic drum set that can be silent
- ◯ a soundproofing service for the home

Question 5 of 6: Choose the best answer.

- ◯ because it can be played without additional equipment
- ◯ because steel strings last longer
- ◯ because the strings are less painful to use
- ◯ because it has a nicer sound

Question 6 of 6: Choose the best answer to each question

- ◯ because he knows people with electric guitars
- ◯ because he will be able to play loud music
- ◯ because of the quality of the sound
- ◯ because it is easier for beginners to learn

PART 4

Listening to a News Item

1. The community garden is part of _____
- ◯ a public park area.
- ◯ government land.
- ◯ an unused grass area.
- ◯ the Hendricks' garden.

2. The Hendricks started the garden to _____
- ◯ meet their neighbours.
- ◯ reduce their food bill.
- ◯ enjoy their hobby.
- ◯ help local wildlife.

3. The people building the garden were _____
- ◯ retired.
- ◯ local residents.
- ◯ local workers.
- ◯ mostly students.

4. They added the pond to _____
- ◯ water the gardens.
- ◯ help endangered frogs.
- ◯ make the area prettier.
- ◯ grow aquatic plants.

5. People were enthusiastic because they could _____
- ◯ sell flowers and vegetables.
- ◯ give a home to wildlife.
- ◯ enjoy being outdoors.
- ◯ socialize and grow vegetables.

PART 5

Listening to a Discussion

1. Which department do Larry and Brenda work for?
- ◯ Customer Service
- ◯ Sales and Marketing
- ◯ Human Resources
- ◯ Technology

2. According to Brenda and Larry, what is one of Tom's strengths?
- ◯ He has been a sales assistant for 3 years.
- ◯ He writes top quality reference letters.
- ◯ He helps co-workers make beautiful charts.
- ◯ He is popular with all of his colleagues.

3. What does the company provide?
- ◯ technical products
- ◯ consulting services
- ◯ communication training
- ◯ marketing and sales advice

4. How does Tom initially feel about his co-workers' suggestion?
- ◯ He is excited.
- ◯ He is reluctant.
- ◯ He is devastated.
- ◯ He is unsurprised.

5. Why do Brenda and Larry collect references?
- ◯ to understand Tom's previous job
- ◯ to update Tom's personnel files
- ◯ to determine Tom's suitability
- ◯ to assess Tom's popularity

6. What worries Tom about presenting to potential clients?
- ◯ The clients won't like him.
- ◯ He lacks specialized knowledge.
- ◯ His clients have specific needs.
- ◯ He is new to working in sales.

PART 5

7. What does the woman want Tom to do?

- ◯ prepare his own sales talk
- ◯ listen to presentations by other staff
- ◯ meet with her potential clients
- ◯ give a presentation at his old school

8. What do Tom's two co-workers convey at the end?

- ◯ They are confident Tom will win this year's top sales award.
- ◯ They are delighted that they have changed Tom's feelings.
- ◯ They are optimistic that Tom's skills will increase rapidly.
- ◯ They are pleased that Tom said he would accept their offer.

PART 6

Listening for Viewpoints

1. The speaker regards the suburbs with _____

- ◯ detachment.
- ◯ curiosity.
- ◯ disdain.
- ◯ sarcasm.

2. The presentation's main theme is that the suburbs _____

- ◯ are still considered suitable places to raise families.
- ◯ bring widespread neuroses and hence are shrinking.
- ◯ may or may not survive the end of the fossil fuel era.
- ◯ remain popular despite their psychological drawbacks.

3. Bansal thought moving from the suburbs to the city was _____

- ◯ boring.
- ◯ dangerous.
- ◯ puzzling.
- ◯ therapeutic.

4. We can tell that the essayist Narendra Bansal _____

- ◯ accurately foresaw the future.
- ◯ enjoyed living in a big city.
- ◯ tended toward pessimism.
- ◯ was trained as a psychologist.

5. The demographer, Leigh Stevanoic, thinks suburbanization is _____

- ◯ a favourable economic indicator.
- ◯ enabling people to earn more money.
- ◯ a cultural trend that will soon die.
- ◯ growing too quickly in some places.

6. Sociologist and author Manuel Rubio most likely _____

- ◯ considers himself easily satisfied.
- ◯ drives an efficient automobile.
- ◯ has a youthful urban lifestyle.
- ◯ resents his life in the suburbs.

Answer Key

PART 1	
Question 1	to ask for more time
Question 2	
Question 3	The bus will stop at many places.
Question 4	He isn't content with the restaurant choice.
Question 5	She feels responsible for the group.
Question 6	He left the restaurant a while ago.
Question 7	She offers him some solutions.
Question 8	appreciation

PART 2	
Question 1	a sprinkler playground
Question 2	It does not have air conditioning.
Question 3	She looks sad.
Question 4	She is concerned about germs.
Question 5	It is an excellent idea.

click here to hear the audios

PART 3	
Question 1	He hasn't had any formal music instruction.
Question 2	He enjoys playing music.
Question 3	provide the best information
Question 4	an electronic drum set that can be silent
Question 5	because the strings are less painful to use
Question 6	because he knows people with electric guitars

PART 4	
Question 1	an unused grass area.
Question 2	enjoy their hobby.
Question 3	local residents.
Question 4	water the gardens.
Question 5	socialize and grow vegetables.

PART 5	
Question 1	Sales and Marketing
Question 2	He is popular with all of his colleagues.
Question 3	technical products
Question 4	He is reluctant.
Question 5	to determine Tom's suitability
Question 6	He lacks specialized knowledge.
Question 7	listen to presentations by other staff
Question 8	They are optimistic that Tom's skills will increase rapidly.

PART 6	
Question 1	curiosity.
Question 2	remain popular despite their psychological drawbacks.
Question 3	therapeutic.
Question 4	tended toward pessimism.
Question 5	a favourable economic indicator.
Question 6	has a youthful urban lifestyle.

PART 1

Transcripts

Listening to Problem Solving

You will hear a conversation between a man and a woman on a tour bus. The man is part of the tour group, and the woman is the bus tour guide.

Section 1:

MAN: Excuse me, are we stopping at the art museum next? For an hour?

WOMAN: Yes, it has a wonderful collection of eighteenth-century furniture. I think you'll find it very interesting.

MAN: Yes, I think you're right, which is why I wanted to ask if we could stay longer. I doubt an hour will be enough time.

WOMAN: I'm afraid we're on a tight schedule. If we stay longer, we won't be able to get to the rest of our stops.

MAN: But couldn't I stay longer? I don't mind missing the next stop. I really don't like wine—not really into tasting and drinking. Perhaps you can come back and get me?

WOMAN: Sorry, I'm afraid we can't do that either. If I approve such a thing for you, everyone will want to be staying longer here and there.

Now answer questions 1-3.

1. Why does the man approach the woman?
2. What exhibit is at the museum?
3. What is true of the bus tour?

Section 2:

WOMAN: Is everyone ready for lunch? We'll be stopping at a popular vegetarian restaurant shortly.

MAN: Couldn't we stop somewhere else instead? I'm not sure I like vegetarian food. Maybe we could go to a place that sells burgers and fries?

WOMAN: I'm afraid we've already booked a restaurant. With a group this size, it's hard to find enough tables at the last minute. We also want quick service since we're on a schedule.

MAN: Yes, but we haven't paid yet. There are probably other restaurants nearby. Couldn't we all just go where we want and meet back at the bus at, say, one o'clock?

WOMAN: I'd rather the group stay together, sir. If anyone gets lost or into some kind of trouble—

MAN: I'm sure we can manage. We're all adults here.

WOMAN: I'm sorry, sir—I didn't mean to imply you couldn't manage on your own. But accidents can happen, and I'd like to be able to provide help in that case.

Now answer questions 4-5.

4. Why does the man want to change the lunch plan?
5. What is likely the reason for the woman's response?

Transcripts

Section 3:

MAN: Excuse me, could we go back? I forgot my umbrella at the restaurant.

WOMAN: Oh dear, it's quite a way back. We wouldn't be able to keep to our schedule.

MAN: But it is looking like rain, and I'd really like to have my umbrella.
WOMAN: The rest of our stops are indoors, and I'd be happy to lend you my umbrella, sir.

MAN: But I'd really like to go back and get my own umbrella. It's an expensive one.

WOMAN: What I'll do right now is call the restaurant and ask them to keep it safe until you can go back on your own. Would that be okay? Or perhaps they'll send it to you, if you'd give them your address.

MAN: That's a great idea—thank you! I'd be able to pick it up after the tour. I suppose I can use my raincoat in the meantime.

Now answer questions 6-8.

6. What is likely true about the man?
7. How does the woman help the man?
8. What is the man's reaction to the woman's response?

Transcripts

Listening to a Daily Life Conversation

You are about to hear a conversation between two people, a man and a woman, who know each other. The conversation takes place in a park while they are watching their kids play.

MAN: It's a hot one today, isn't it?

WOMAN: Yes, it is very hot. Our apartment doesn't have air conditioning, so I really look forward to being here in the park in the middle of the day!

MAN: Same here, and for the same reason! It's nice that these benches are in the shade and still close enough to the playground equipment. Minji doesn't look very happy today—is your daughter ill?

WOMAN: No, Minji's fine. She wanted to go to the swimming pool, but I said 'no.' It's just too long a bus ride on a hot day like today.

MAN: I know what you mean. You know, I was thinking, before you came, that they should have some sprinklers or fountains here, for the kids to play in. There's an open space right over there that's not being used.

WOMAN: They say we'll be having more hot spells like this . . .

MAN: It could be a lot of fun—there could be water shooting out of different spouts, some stationary and some spinning around . . . We could call it a sprinkler playground! It should be free, of course!

WOMAN: Of course, and you know, letting kids run through sprinklers would probably be a lot more hygienic than letting them swim in a communal pool. I confess I worry about what Minji might catch when she goes swimming at the pool—ear infections, eye infections . . .

MAN: You might be right. The water would continuously wash away. The kids could still wear their bathing suits, but also sneakers or special water shoes.

WOMAN: I suspect a sprinkler playground would use less water than a swimming pool. Did you know that they're talking about rationing the water again this summer, at least for watering lawns?

MAN: Yes, I heard that. Perhaps I should send my suggestion to the City Parks and Recreation Department.

WOMAN: I think you should! On a day like today, even I'd use it. Just as I am!

Now answer questions 1-5.

1. What is the main topic of discussion?
2. What is true of the man's apartment?
3. Why does the man ask if Minji is sick?
4. Why is the woman reluctant to take Minji to swimming pools?
5. What does the woman think of the man's suggestion?

Transcripts

Listening for Information

You will hear a conversation where a woman needs information about musical instruments.

MAN: Hi, welcome to Music And More. Can I help you?

WOMAN: Hi! Yes, I'm looking for either a guitar or a drum set. It's for my son, for his birthday. He's always wanted either of those two instruments. Could you tell me a little bit about both?

MAN: Has your son played either instrument before?

WOMAN: Well, he had a toy drum set when he was five and loved it so much that he broke it. He's thirteen now. His friends all play guitar and sometimes he tries playing on their guitars, but he's never taken lessons. I'd prefer if he played the guitar. I think drums would be too noisy; our house has very poor sound insulation.

MAN: Well, we have options that will make both you and your son happy. We sell regular drum sets, but if soundproofing is a concern we do sell electronic drums that you can plug headphones into, so then you won't hear a thing.

WOMAN: Wow! That certainly would be nice. What about guitars?

MAN: You could get a classical acoustic guitar, or an electric guitar. For a beginner, I'd recommend a classical acoustic with nylon strings. Nylon strings are softer on the fingers and are much easier to learn on.

WOMAN: All his friends have electric guitars, so he'd probably want an electric one too.

MAN: The good thing about the electric guitar is that, like electronic drums, he can plug headphones in and you won't hear him practice. However, electric guitars have steel strings. They can be quite painful on the fingers for beginners, and he may get frustrated and give up quickly.

WOMAN: I see. Well there's quite a few options. Which is the most affordable?

MAN: An electronic drum set would set you back the most. They start at around $700. A beginner electric guitar would be a lot cheaper and a regular acoustic guitar would be the cheapest. We have some nice quality ones that are on sale right now.

WOMAN: I think an electric guitar might be the way to go. I know it has steel strings, but I think he'd get used to it. Could you show me some?

MAN: Certainly! We have a great variety of styles. Please follow me!

Now answer questions 1-6.

1. What musical experience does the woman's son have?
2. Why does the woman want to buy her son a musical instrument?
3. What was the man trying to do?
4. What solution does the man offer for the drums?
5. Why does the man say the acoustic guitar might be better?
6. Why does the woman think her son will prefer the electric guitar?

Transcripts

Listening to a News Item

You will hear a news story about a couple who started a community garden.

Recently arrived residents Mike and Paula Hendricks are delighted that the community garden they started this spring in their townhouse complex in Arnprior, Ontario, has turned out to be a big hit. The couple have been avid gardeners for years. Mike said they were disappointed that there weren't any nearby community gardens to join. They decided to start their own.

They soon found that almost everyone in the area was enthusiastic about the idea. A team of thirty residents converted a large unused patch of grass into gardening plots. They filled the beds with soil and compost. They also dug a pond to collect rainwater for watering plants.

Now the garden is packed with vegetables, flowers, and people. One resident, Atsuko Tanaka, said that it's a great place to hang out and socialize with the neighbours. Another man said he was delighted to find that growing his own vegetables cut down his grocery bill. The local wildlife seem to benefit as well. Gardener and biologist John Cheney, who is researching frog populations in the area, is thrilled that the pond is now home to a species of endangered frogs. Paula said there's something for everyone in the community garden.

Transcripts

Listening to a Discussion

You will watch a conversation among three co-workers—two men and one woman. They get together in a meeting room to discuss a new work assignment for one of them.

Larry: Tom! Brenda and I want to talk to you about presentations.

Tom: Presentations? What about them?

Brenda: Well, we're the sales force. We do all the sales pitches. We meet with potential clients on a regular basis and show them our products in hopes to acquire new accounts. And . . . we think that you should come on board.

Tom: You want me to start doing sales pitches? Look, I don't have the skills or the experience.

Larry: Tom, why would you say that? You started with the company, what, about a year ago as a sales assistant? Since then, you've worked in three different departments and you've done very well in all three.

Brenda: Absolutely. We've been talking with your past and current co-workers to get references, and they all speak very highly of you. You do beautiful charts, top-notch reports, and everybody really seems to like you! How did you manage that, by the way?

Tom: I don't know, I just help them out when they ask me for things. I try to give them what they need.

Brenda: See? That is the mark of a great salesperson! Identifying the individual's needs and delivering to their expectations!

Larry: Hold on, Brenda. Tom didn't seem particularly excited when we offered him the opportunity to start pitching. Now I think it's important that Tom tell us exactly what it is that's bothering him.

Tom: Well, it's a couple of things, really. I don't feel like I'm competent. What if they ask me questions about our product that I can't answer? Technical questions?

Larry: I'm sure you know more than you think you know. Plus you're a great communicator. I don't think there's anything here that can't be solved with a little bit of preparation.

Tom: I'm also not that keen on public speaking. I mean, I'm good one-on-one, but I remember even back at school, when I had to do presentations . . . You know, when you start to blush, and you're breathing, and your mouth gets dry, and your palms start to get sweaty . . .

Brenda: Tom, I think that you should attend some important sales presentations with our more senior sales representatives. I think that'll help you get some confidence and be more sure of yourself. It'll really help you fight that stage fright.

Larry: I agree. A little observation, a little preparation, a little practice—you'd be amazed at how far it can go. You wouldn't believe how bad I was when I first started.

Brenda: And now he's winning awards! You mark my words, Tom, you're gonna follow in his footsteps. Welcome aboard!

Transcripts

Listening for Viewpoints

You will hear a presentation about life in the suburbs.

Suburbs: They're a curious beast. They're neither urban nor rural, and their sole purpose is to provide a space for domestic life. With their homogenous architecture and thematic subdivisions, they're often perceived as ugly. Their visual monotony stems in part from the fact they were meticulously planned—in contrast to city centres, which evolved organically and haphazardly over time, in response to changing economic influences.

But ever since the internal combustion engine revolutionized commuting, the suburbs have attracted the inhabitants of the cramped and chaotic inner city and lured them out to the periphery.

In the 1970s, essayist Narendra Bansal described how this would-be paradise evolved to embody the worst of the post-modern world. Bansal said that suburbanites had opted out of the vibrant urban communities that held society together. She predicted that suburbanites' alienation and boredom would eventually give rise to an anxiety epidemic. This anxiety, she felt, would eventually make suburbanites return to closer-knit, psychologically healthier urban neighborhoods. So in fact, the prefabricated houses and manicured lawns that gave the suburbs their initial appeal would eventually be their downfall. In 2008, suburban sprawl was curtailed by the financial crisis. It was then that Bansal went from disdain to doom-mongering. She famously declared that the death of the suburb was at hand.

This dismal view of suburbia was unwarranted, says demographer Leigh Stevanoic. She maintains that families and professionals are flocking to the suburbs—especially in the developing world, where rapid economic growth has been associated with declining urban density. Stevanoic suggests that as populations gain in wealth, they consume more goods and take up more space. This trend, she says, is proof that we are not witnessing suburbia's demise. Instead, she believes we are witnessing how a growing global middle class is affecting settlement patterns.

Sociologist and bestselling author Manuel Rubio observes that millions of people around the globe are lining up to swap urban frenzy for suburban tranquility. However, Rubio questions whether global suburbia can survive the war on global warming, since car culture is one of suburbia's most persistent features. Meanwhile, in the first world, Rubio sees the young, the bored, and the frustrated turning their collective backs on the white picket fence world they sprang from. To Rubio, this suggests that suburban life satisfies people who are willing to settle for less, but that it can't satisfy the appetites of those eager for material success. Perhaps Bansal's prophecy of mass anxiety is being realized in at least some of the population.